Section Overview

- Introduction to CUDA, SGEMM, and the Naive Kernel

What is GEMM?

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Example

During the forward pass when training a model, we accumulate the gradients from the entire batch.

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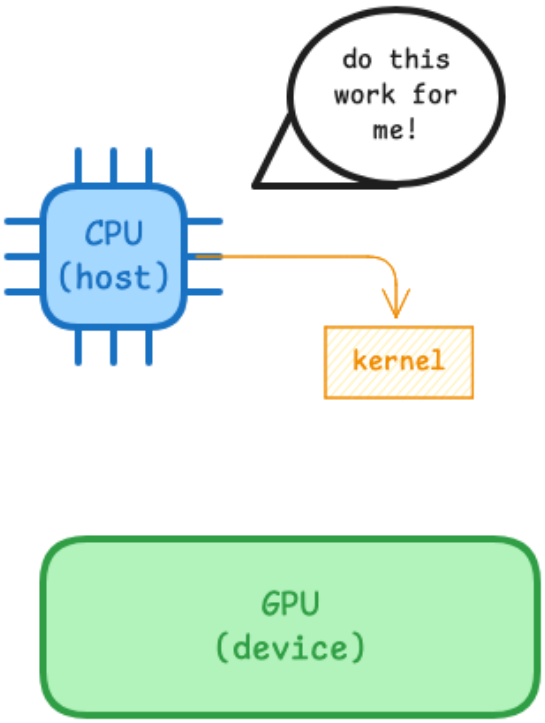
```
sgemm(
  int M, int N, int K,
  float alpha, float *A, float *B,
  float beta, float *C
)
```

$$\underbrace{A}_{M\times K} \quad \underbrace{B}_{K\times N} \quad \underbrace{C}_{M\times N}$$

- M: rows of A and C
- N: columns of B and C
- K: shared reduction dimension

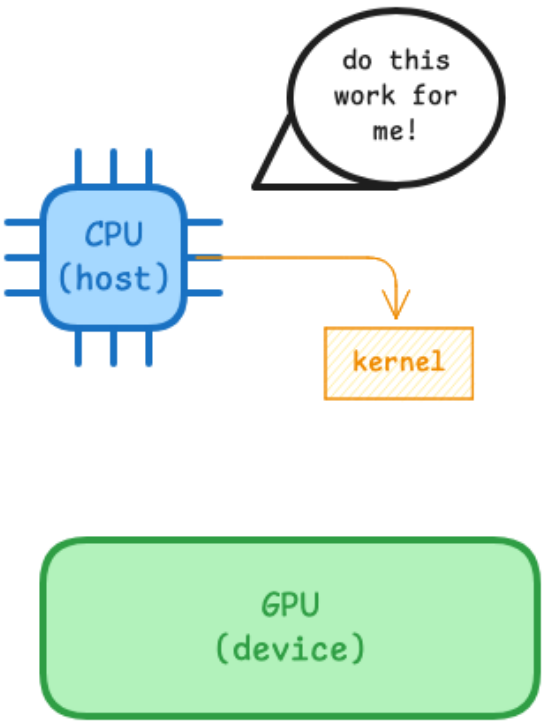
CUDA Basics (Host vs. Device)

- The CPU is known as the **host**, and manages top level logic.
- The GPU is known as the **device**, and does the heavy lifting.
- The host launches **kernels** to the device.



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```
int main() {
  const int M = 128, N = 128, K = 128;

  float *dA, *dB, *dC;
  cudaMalloc(&dA, M * K * sizeof(float);
  cudaMalloc(&dB, K * N * sizeof(float));
  cudaMalloc(&dC, M * N * sizeof(float));

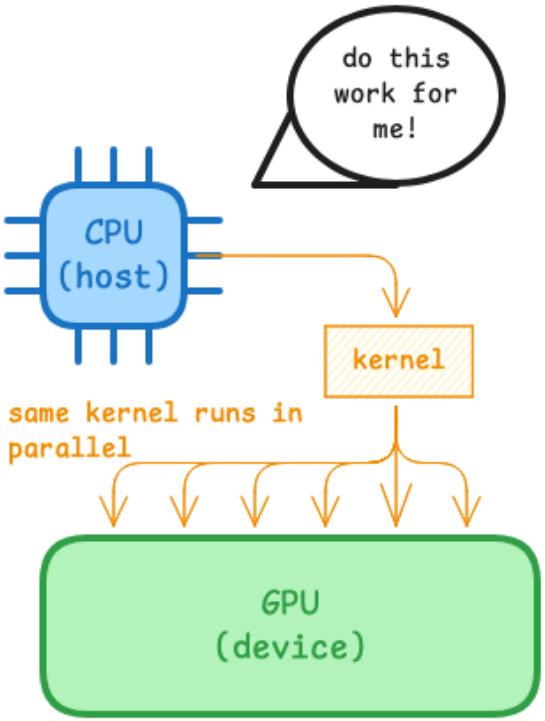
  // load values into these device pointers...

  run_sgemm_naive(M, N, K, 1, dA, dB, 0, dC);

  cudaFree(dA); cudaFree(dB); cudaFree(dC);
}
```

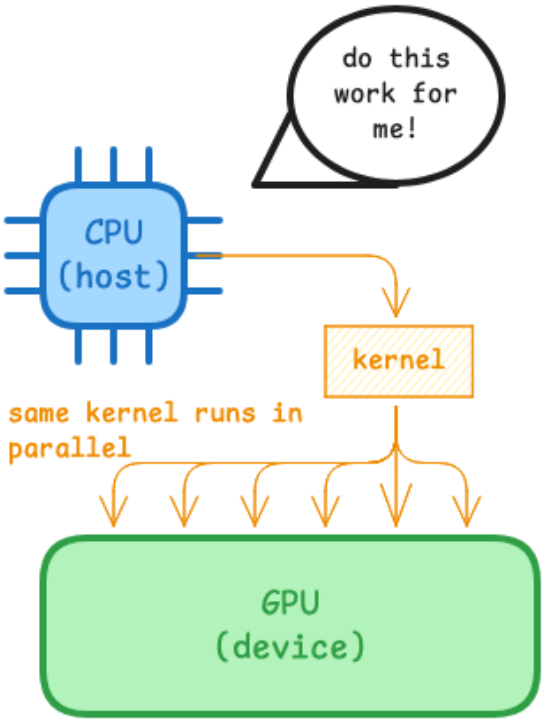
CUDA Basics (Kernel Execution)

- A kernel runs in parallel on many **threads** on the device.
- The number of threads the device allocates is configured by the host, when it **launches** the kernel.



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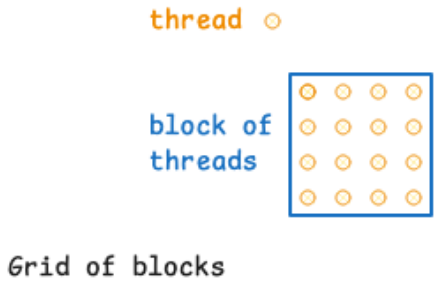



```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  // implementation hidden for now ...
}
```

```
void launch_sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int K,
                        const float alpha, const float *A, const float *B,
                        const float beta, float *C) {
  constexpr int block_size = 32;
  const dim3 threads(block_size, block_size);
  const dim3 blocks((N + block_size - 1) / block_size,
                    (M + block_size - 1) / block_size);
  sgemm_naive<<<blocks, threads>>>(M, N, K, alpha, A, B, beta, C);
}
```

CUDA Basics (Threads, Blocks, Grids)

- Threads are grouped into **blocks**.
- The collection of blocks requested by the host is organized in a **grid**.




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This hierarchy is closely related to how the device schedules the execution. We will see later how to use this to optimize performance.

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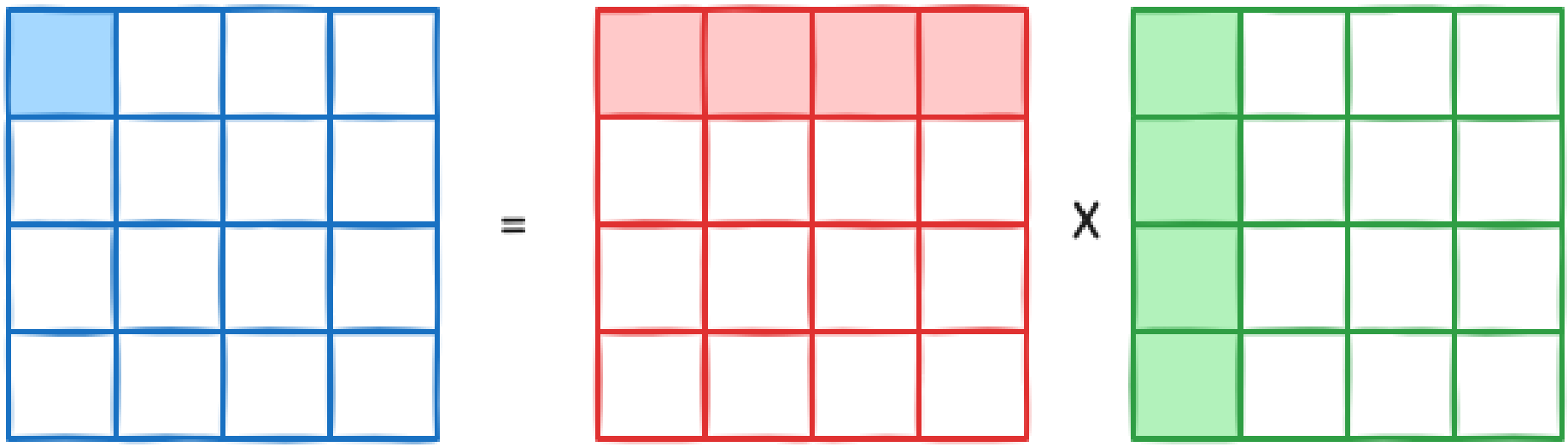
Thread, Block, Grid hierarchy

Threads are grouped into blocks of constant size/shape.
Blocks are launched as a grid.
We choose the dimensions of the grid to control how many blocks are launched, and thus how many threads are launched.

Let's design a SGEMM kernel!

Recall

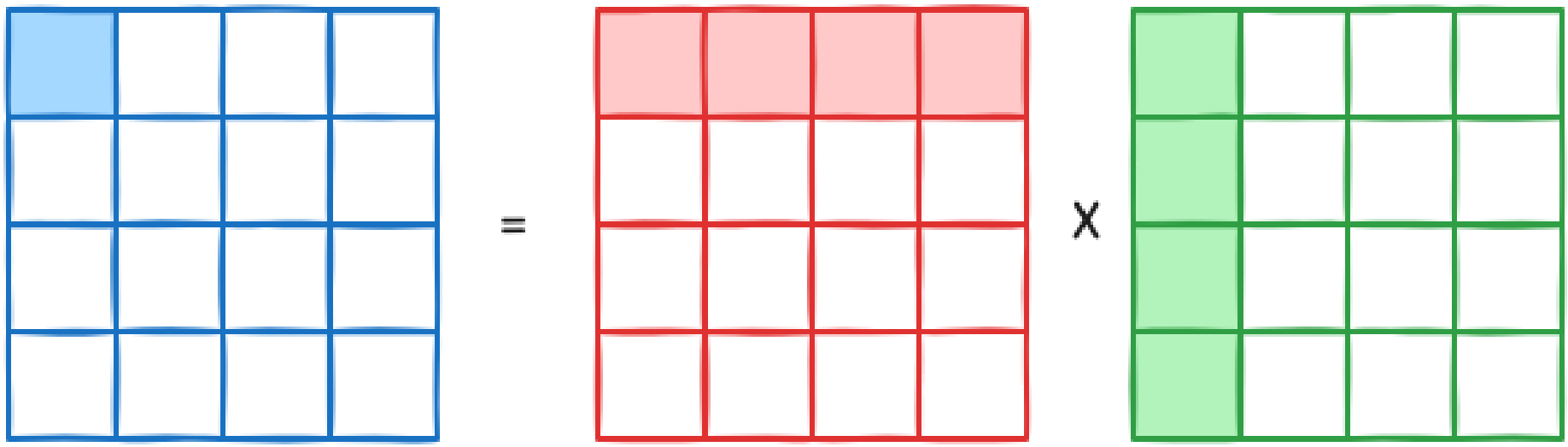
Recall that matrix multiplication is naturally parallel, and the output elements of C can be computed independently in parallel.



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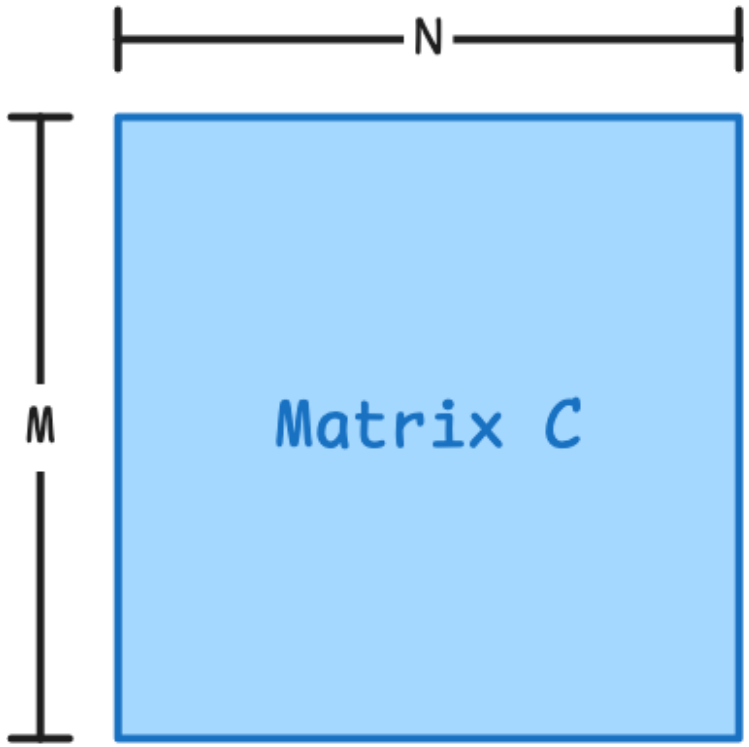
We can naturally map one thread to each output element!

Naive SGEMM Kernel

```
__global__ void sgemm_naive(const int M, const int N, const int
      K,
                            const float alpha, const float *A,
      const float *B,
                            const float beta, float *C) {
  const int y = blockIdx.y * blockDim.y + threadIdx.y;
  const int x = blockIdx.x * blockDim.x + threadIdx.x;

  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0.0f;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; ++i) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
    }
    C[y * N + x] = alpha * sum + beta * C[y * N + x];
  }
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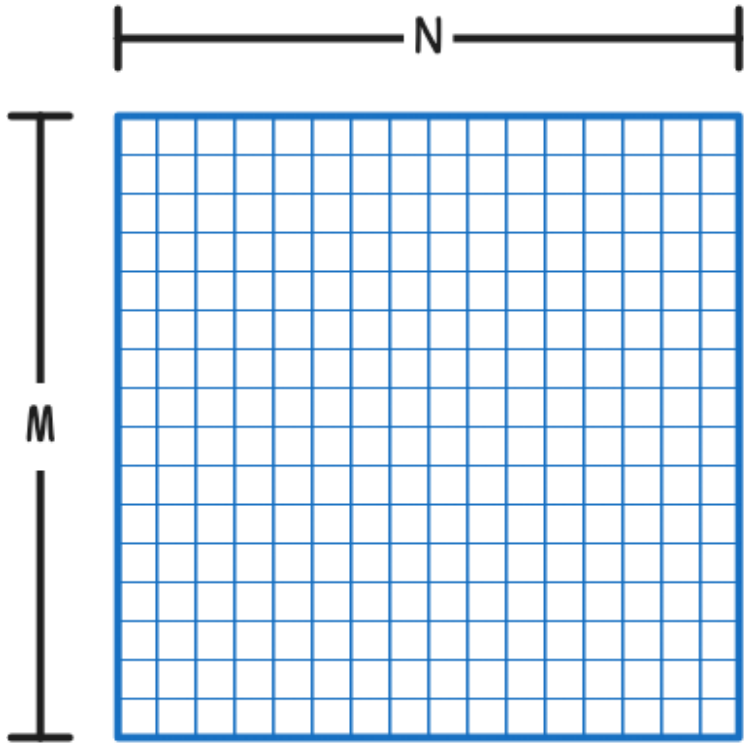


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  if (y < M && x < N) {
    float sum = 0.0f;
    for (int i = 0; i < K; ++i) {
      sum += A[y * K + i] * B[i * N + x];
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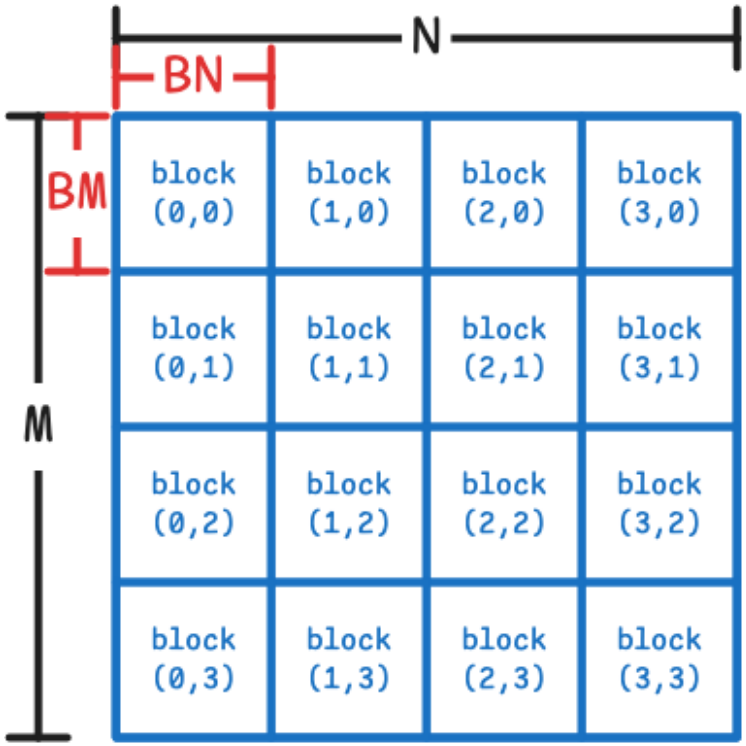


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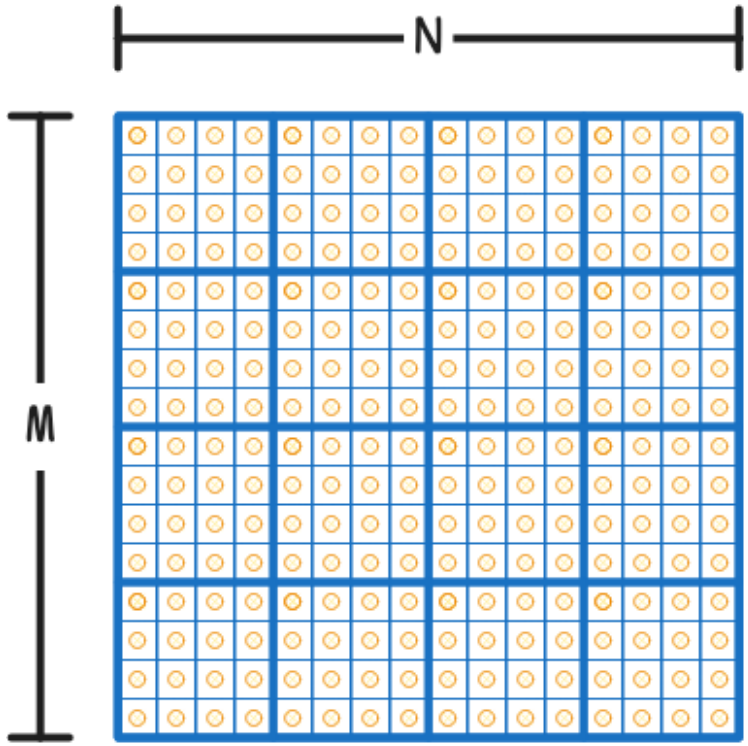


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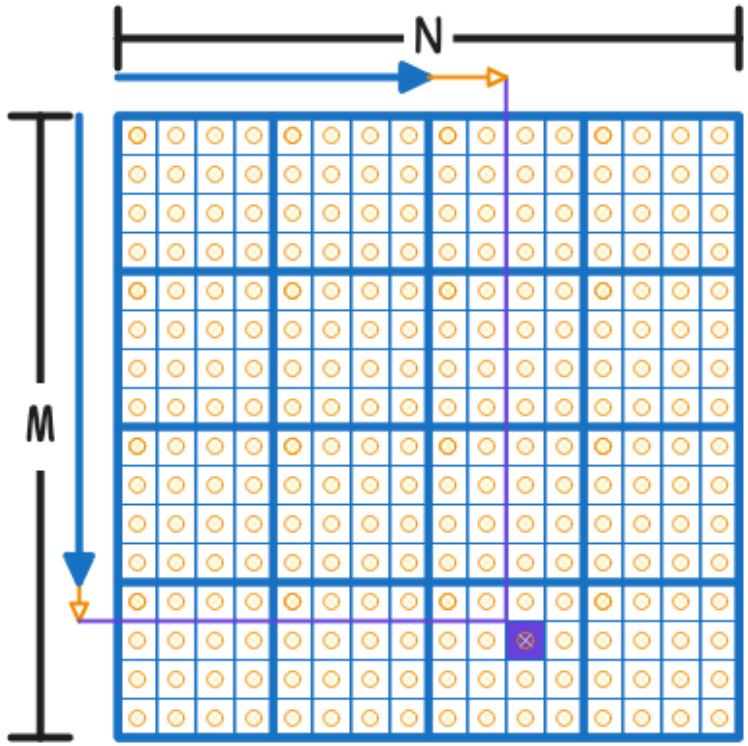


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}
```



Naive SGEMM visualization

- One thread computes one element of C.
- It walks one row of A and one column of B for the full dot product.

Play naive-kernel visualization

Naive CUDA is already faster than the CPU

